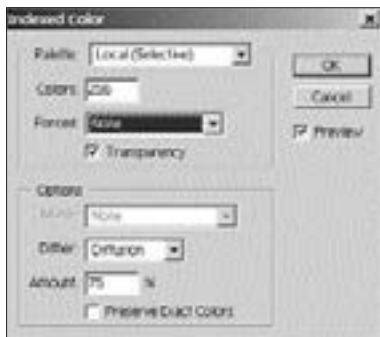


- important but small size for quicker loading is the criteria.
- GIF is a no-no for print purposes or for further editing.

9.2.1 Setting transparency in GIF using Photoshop

You can make the background of a gif transparent such that only the selected portion of the gif will be visible while the remaining parts show the background on which the GIF is placed. This makes it very easy to place images on web pages without the page itself losing its look and feel. If the web page has a Grey background, just image how it would look if small images with a Reddish background are placed all over it!



Setting the GIF Transparency

Using the Magic Wand or Lasso tool, select the area of the image you want transparent and delete them by pressing [Del]. Now choose to save the image as a GIF and click on Save. You will then be prompted to choose palette options. In this box, check the option that says ~Transparency~ and say ~OK~. Now you can use this image on any background and have only the subject of the GIF visible with its background transparent.

9.3 The PNG format

Often pronounced as 'Ping', the Portable Network Graphics format was created to replace the GIF image format. PNG offers better compression than GIF but does not support animations. PNG compression is fully lossless and supports up to 48-bit per pixel for colour or 16-bit greyscale. Being an open platform scheme, a PNG image created by any supporting software will be readable by others. Drop Shadow effects and variable transparencies make PNG the preferred choice over GIFs where animations are not required.